



CODECHEF

The CodeChef.com Challenge—your monthly dose of coding puzzles from India's biggest coding contest, now in print!

*H*ello and welcome to the CodeChef Puzzle Challenge sponsored by *LINUX* For You and Directi! Let's see how many of you can solve this month's puzzle, and which one of you will be amongst the three lucky winners of a cash prize of Rs 1000!

Last month's puzzle

What are the total number of ways to get the following equation correct by inserting mathematical operators (+, -, /, *): $77777 = 55$

The solution

The total number of ways to get the equation $77777 = 55$ correct by inserting mathematical operators (+, -, /, *) is FOUR.

How did we do it?

The simplest solution would be Brute Force,

as there are only four possible positions for inserting operators and each position can take up any one of the four operators. Thus, a Brute Force solution will only explore $4^4 = 256$ cases.

And the winners for July are...

- Sunish Kumar
- Rajesh Kalra
- Basavraj Patil

Puzzle for August

Ten friends start from their respective homes at the same time to meet any one of the other friends. They choose to meet anyone with equal likelihood. All of them take equal time to reach the other friend's home, and given that none of them use the same route, what is the probability that none of them meet.

Looking for a little extra cash?

Solve this month's CodeChef Challenge puzzle and send in your answer to codechef@efyindia.com. Three lucky winners will get Rs 1,000 in cash!  

About CodeChef: CodeChef.com is India's first, non-commercial, online programming competition, featuring monthly contests in more than 35 different programming languages. CodeChef has been created by Directi, as a way to continuously challenge and engage the developer community. The goal is to provide a platform for practice, competition and improvement as well as enable developers to benchmark their skills against their peers. Log on to www.codechef.com for the August Challenge that takes place from August 1st to the 11th, 2010, to win cash prizes of up to Rs 55,000.